Dad's Policies, Annuities, Retirement Accounts and Benefits in One Place

What you have, where it is and when it was last looked at.

Dad mentions a policy he bought years ago and an annuity from somewhere. The paperwork is in the filing cabinet, he thinks.

This page doesn't ask you to read or understand any of it. Go through it with Dad, and for each thing write where the paperwork is, the date on it, when anyone last looked at it, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE, AND WHEN IT WAS LAST LOOKED AT	WHO HAS IT
Long-term care insurance policy, if he has one			
Life insurance policies			
Annuity contracts, and the latest statement for each			
Retirement account statements, one for each company that holds an account			
Pension paperwork			
Health coverage: his cards and plan papers			
Veterans benefit paperwork, if Dad served			
Letters about any other benefit he receives or has asked about			
Paperwork for any funeral or burial arrangement already made			
The agent, company or office to call about each of these, with a phone number			

What nobody has looked at lately, and who will call

Any row where “last looked at” is years ago or unknown. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE The long-term care policy. Dad bought it while he was still working and nobody has read it since. Karen will find the company's phone number on the last premium notice.

What hasn't turned up yet, and who will look for it

Anything Dad mentions that has no paperwork in hand. Don't guess what it is.

FOR EXAMPLE Dad remembers an annuity but there's no contract in the filing cabinet. He'll watch the mail for a statement and we'll look again then.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each item. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- For “last looked at,” write when someone last read it through or spoke to the company about it. “Unknown” is a fair answer.
- Leave policy numbers, account numbers, Social Security numbers and passwords off this page. Just say where the paper is.
- Don't rewrite or summarize a document here, and don't move one without Dad knowing where it went.
- Put today's date on the page, and agree with Dad when you'll look at it again.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any policy, contract or benefit letter means, what it covers or what it is worth, and it doesn't say how any of them would be treated if Dad needed care. If you read something you don't understand, that's a question for the company that issued it or for a licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial, tax or insurance advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know which policies and benefits Dad has, where the paperwork is, and which ones nobody has read lately. The planning interview is the next step: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep this page beside you while you answer.

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